

Samsung SL-45A for Military & Defense

Heavy CNC lathe purpose-built for forged blanks, rough shafts, drive mandrels, and structural stock. This paper covers what the machine does, the military & defense parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes military & defense buyers expect, and the documentation package.

14" OD × 96" L max turning
ENVELOPE

±0.0005" routine after roughing
TOLERANCE

1994
SINCE

Same-week / rig-down direct
RESPONSE



Hammer of Forge · 14" OD × 96" L max turning · heavy-duty CNC lathe for rough stock

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Executive summary

Machine: Samsung SL-45A/2200 (shop nickname: *Hammer of Forge*). heavy-duty CNC lathe for rough stock at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop.

Application: Heavy CNC lathe purpose-built for forged blanks, rough shafts, drive mandrels, and structural stock for Military & Defense customers — Defense primes, subassembly manufacturers, tactical vehicle component OEMs, munitions component suppliers, weapon-system integrators, sustainment (out-of-production replacement) contractors.

Envelope: 14" OD × 96" L max turning. **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features. **Traceability:** Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

Hammer of Forge is the machine that takes ugly starting material and makes it round, straight, and to size. Forged blanks with scale and skin, rough saw-cut billets, oversized bar stock — this machine has the rigidity and horsepower to get through the roughing pass without chatter and without walking the part. Most of what our other lathes finish, this one starts.

Why Hammer of Forge for Defense work

Defense parts in 4140 pre-hard and 4340 frequently start as forgings or heavy bar, and getting through that stock predictably is its own capability. 14" OD × 96", a 6.5" bar capacity, and a 3-speed gearbox putting torque where heavy removal happens.

What this looks like on a real part

4140 in the pre-hardened condition is where a lot of shops get caught out. It arrives already heat treated to something like 28–32 HRC, which means there's no soft machining stage to hide in — every cut is into hardened material. It cuts predictably if you respect it: rigid setup, committed depth of cut, and no dwelling, because a tool that stops advancing in pre-hard steel starts rubbing and work-hardening the surface for the next pass.

When this is the wrong machine

Roughing machine. Defense tolerance work gets finished on a Hi-Eco cell or Torque & Tumble.
Non-export-controlled work only.

Full specifications

Model	Samsung SL-45A/2200 ("Hammer of Forge")
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Type	Heavy-duty CNC turning center — Samsung SL-45A platform
Max turning capacity	14" OD × 96" L (B&R working spec)
Platform max swing	29.72" over bed; 24.8" swing over cross slide
Platform max machining Ø	26.7"
Platform max length	118" between centers
Bar capacity	6.5" through spindle
Spindle speed	2,000 RPM max (3-speed gearbox)
Main motor	50 HP continuous / 40 HP rated
Tailstock	Programmable #5 MT (full-length support for slender parts)
Turret	12-position
Tolerance capability	±0.0005" routine after roughing; excellent for finish passes
Materials	Forgings, castings, bar stock — 4140/4340, stainless, Inconel, Duplex, 17-4 PH

Values marked "platform" reflect the machine manufacturer's published spec range for this platform family; B&R's working spec is what we quote on this specific unit.

Who this serves in Military & Defense

Typical buyer: Defense primes, subassembly manufacturers, tactical vehicle component OEMs, munitions component suppliers, weapon-system integrators, sustainment (out-of-production replacement) contractors.

What's hard about military & defense work: Sensitive prints, program-specific quality plans, tight-tolerance structural components, exotic-alloy selection driven by service environment, and legacy-part sustainment where the OEM no longer supports the design and the prime's supply chain has moved on.

Typical Military & Defense parts we produce on Hammer of Forge

- Rough-turning of defense forgings
- Structural round parts starting from forgings
- Weapon-component blanks and roughing pass
- Vehicle-component large-diameter roughing
- Roughing to prep parts for finish on precision machines

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Military & Defense

Standard range: 17-4 PH · 15-5 PH · 13-8 Mo · 4140 pre-hard · 4340 · Titanium Grade 5 · Inconel 718 · Aluminum 7075 · High-strength steels · Customer-specific alloys on request.

Defense parts routinely spec 4140 pre-hard, 4340, and precipitation-hardening stainless — condition-specific machining knowledge matters, same as aerospace. Titanium is common on weight-critical structural components. Legacy sustainment often specifies materials nobody sees anywhere else; we work with the spec sheet you provide and validate machining strategy before we cut.

What "we run these weekly" means: we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

How we machine it — our 5-step process

This is the process B&R runs on every job, military & defense or otherwise. The specifics of feeds, speeds, and tooling shift by alloy and machine; the discipline is universal.

1

Material verification. Every job starts with material traceability. Heat and lot numbers documented against the mill test report. For customer-supplied material, we verify against the CofC before touching the stock.

2

First-article layout. Stock is measured and laid out before any cutting starts. Concentricity, roundness, and squareness of the starting material established; if the stock is out of tolerance we call the customer before wasting time on a bad blank.

3

Roughing with process control for the alloy. Feeds, speeds, and coolant strategy set for the specific alloy family — sharp coated carbide (or PCD for high-volume Ti Grade 5), positive rake, high-pressure through-tool coolant on 2507 and Inconel to control cutting temperature. Interrupted cuts get extra attention because they cycle heat into the workpiece.

4

Finish pass to spec. Finish pass with a fresh insert, controlled DOC, and measured surface-finish targets. Critical features (bore concentricity, seat grooves, sealing surfaces) are held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer.

5

CMM verification + documentation. Every critical dimension CMM-verified. First-article report generated. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery. If your quality group needs a documentation package beyond that, tell us with the RFQ and we'll be straight about what we can and can't produce in-house.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Military & Defense

±0.0005" routine on critical features. Tighter with proper setup and fixture. GD&T-driven tolerancing supported. CMM verification on first articles; customer-plan-driven measurement on production runs. Documentation the level a program office expects.

Documentation and quality workflow

Sensitive prints handled under NDA with document control — prints stay in-shop and aren't sent to outside vendors. First-article documentation standard. Material traceability by heat and lot on every job. Certificates of conformance with delivery. One thing we state plainly up front: B&R is not ITAR-registered with the U.S. State Department. If your print is ITAR-controlled, we are not the right shop and we'll tell you that on the first call. Non-controlled defense-adjacent work — commercial-spec components, sustainment parts, tooling, and fixtures — we quote all day.

Response time and emergency work

Program-driven schedules honored. Emergency component replacement supported for sustainment programs with established relationships. Legacy-part reverse-engineering supported for out-of-production sustainment.

How we compare

Compared to a large defense-prime captive shop: we're faster for one-offs, small runs, and legacy sustainment where the prime's supply chain has moved on. Compared to a lowest-bidder commodity shop: we understand the alloys, we document properly, and we don't guess at a condition-specific machining plan. Compared to an ITAR-registered shop: for controlled prints they win, because that's a State Department registration and we don't hold it. Know which bucket your part is in before you shop it — it saves everyone a wasted quote cycle.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request, and prints stay in-shop rather than going out to third-party vendors. Note for defense and aerospace buyers: B&R is not ITAR- or AS9100-registered, so export-controlled prints and AS9100 flow-down programs need a registered shop — we'll tell you that on the first call, not after the PO.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Frequently asked questions

8 questions covering the Samsung SL-45A platform and Military & Defense work. Also indexed as FAQ schema for AI answer engines.

What's the Samsung SL-45A designed for?

Heavy roughing. Forged blanks with scale and skin, rough saw-cut billets, oversized bar stock — this machine has the rigidity and horsepower (50 HP continuous / 40 HP rated, 3-speed gearbox) to get through the roughing pass without chatter or walking the part.

What's the max envelope on the SL-45A?

14" OD × 96" L is B&R's working spec. Platform max is 26.7" machining diameter × 118" between centers with 29.72" swing over bed. Bar capacity: 6.5" through spindle.

What tailstock does the SL-45A carry?

Programmable #5 MT tailstock — full-length support for slender long parts. 12-position turret.

Do you handle ITAR-controlled defense work?

No — and we'd rather be the shop that tells you that up front. ITAR compliance is a registration with the U.S. State Department's DDTC, not a set of practices a shop can simply adopt, and B&R does not hold it. If your print is ITAR-controlled, you need a registered facility. What we do handle: non-controlled defense-adjacent work — commercial-spec components, legacy sustainment parts, tooling, fixtures, and reverse-engineered replacements for programs the OEM walked away from. Sensitive prints stay in-shop under NDA with document control, and first-article documentation and material traceability come standard.

What defense-adjacent parts have you machined?

Weapon subassembly components, defense actuator parts, vehicle armor bracket hardware, sensor housings, hydraulic cylinders for defense platforms, tactical vehicle component reverse-engineering, and legacy-sustainment parts for out-of-production programs.

What alloys are typical for defense work at B&R?

17-4 PH, 15-5 PH, 4140 pre-hard, 4340, Titanium Grade 5, Inconel 718, aluminum 7075, high-strength steels. Customer-specific alloys on request.

Can you reverse-engineer legacy defense parts?

Yes — sustainment work for out-of-production programs is a regular part of our mix. Send a worn sample and any documentation available; we'll produce the replacement with full material traceability.

What tolerances do you hold on defense components?

±0.0005" routine on critical features. Tighter with the right fixture. Every critical dimension CMM-verified. Documentation to customer spec.

Related white papers

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Ready to talk about your Military & Defense work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

Published by B&R Productions — a precision CNC machining shop in New Waverly, Texas, in business since 1994. Serving oil & gas, aerospace, defense, and industrial customers across Texas and the Gulf Coast.

Written by the B&R Productions team. Machine specs verified against manufacturer data. Alloy and process notes reflect shop practice as of 2026-01-15.

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